

any destruction of actual wealth or tangible property, as happens in war.

The financial reviews at the end of the year that dwelt on the extent of the losses did not remind the losers that the first to go were the dream dollars. Everybody who looked for easy money in 1928 or 1929 lost both dreams and cash in 1929 or 1930. In 1931 nobody was spared.

Reckless fools lost first because they deserved to lose, and careful wise men lost later because a world-wide earthquake doesn't ask for personal references.

FOR THE OTHER FELLOW ONLY

The powerful millionaires accumulated minus signs then, when owners and former owners of stocks and bonds consisted of poor, poorer and paupers. Poverty, like riches, is relative. A poor man finds this hard to believe because he thinks in superlatives: Himself and his hardships. The great social equalizer is the common need to live on less than a man has been accustomed to spending; and everybody has had to do that lately. Nevertheless, delusions persist: The delusion that the world, so wonderful during the boom, is going to pot via the lost-money route; that the way to recover from hard times is to keep on hoping that somebody else will do something about it, preferably the politicians or the bankers; that cities, states and Uncle Sam can put off giving the taxpayers their money's worth as long as they try to offset deficits by increasing the taxes of the rich. This last is as great a delusion as the human mind can hold, its chief purpose being to win votes and to increase the burdens of